

Google Smartwatch?

According to reports, Google has jumped on the Smart Watch bandwagon too. Read about an early report of what's cooking: <http://dgit.in/YwgnBc>



Fujifilm XP200

Fujifilm has revealed a new waterproof, shockproof, dustproof and freezeproof camera - the Fujifilm XP200. <http://dgit.in/FuJiXP>

true that the number of Reader users has been steadily dropping, the outcry proves that there are still plenty out there (this article's author included) who use Reader regularly.

Zopfli: Google's Cloud Zip

Google has introduced a new data compression algorithm, which the company believes will make the Internet faster for all users. According to Google, the new algorithm is named after a Swiss bread recipe and is implementation of the Deflate algorithm, which is used in the popular ZIP archive format, as well as in gzip file compression.

"Due to the amount of CPU time required — 2 to 3 orders of magnitude more than zlib at maximum quality — Zopfli is best suited for applications where data is compressed once and sent over a network many times, for example, static content for the web. By open sourcing Zopfli, thus allowing webmasters to better optimize



Google's Zopfli seems cool

the size of frequently accessed static content, we hope to make the Internet a bit faster for all of us," Google concludes in the blog post.

Google further explains in its blog that the output generated by Zopfli is about 3-8 percent smaller as compared to zlib at the maximum compression. Zopfli has been written in C and is a compression-only library. Zopfli is bit-stream compatible with compression used in gzip, Zip, PNG, HTTP requests, and others. Refer to <http://dgit.in/148PVjo> for more details.

Google+ Update

The Google+ interface got the three new updates in March, aimed at making it more visually appealing. Vic Gundotra, Senior VP - Engineering, announced three major design changes which will start rolling out to users soon. Some features have already started showing up in our Google+ pages.

The cover image size has been increased to 2120 x 1192 pixels which will expand to a 16:9 aspect ratio when fully expanded. So now you do not



Google+ is touting a revamped look, too, this spring

have to necessarily only include cover images that are more wider than taller and you can add a lot more images to your Google+ cover. But it also takes up a lot of the screen real-estate, so beware.

The next big announcement was a redesign of the About page which has divided sections into a card-like interface making editing comparatively easier. you have the options to share specific fields with specific circles. Each section under the About tab is colour-coded which adds a nice touch and seems in line with Google's design philosophy.

Yet another feature added is the Local Reviews tab which will sit beside the About, Posts, Photos, YouTube videos, +1s tab on your profile page. This page will basically highlight your restaurant reviews. You also have the option to hide the Local reviews tab, if you so wish. But as far as Google

is concerned, by placing the Local Reviews tab right on the profile page, users may just feel tempted to write more Local reviews, thereby improving Google's social search.

Outlook.com

In late February, Microsoft released its Outlook.com service, shedding the "Preview" status it came with last July. The company will be transitioning all Hotmail accounts to Outlook.com over the next few months. This strategy falls in line with Microsoft's recent push to integrate all its properties under a much simplified banner. Since it didn't make sense running email services under two names (Hotmail and Outlook), an integration of the e-mail client and service under one brand name seems to be the logical move.

Outlook.com was introduced back in July of 2012, and in less than 6 months, the service claims to have racked up 60 million+ users worldwide, making it the fastest growing email service yet. While all new sign-ups are automatically being assigned the Outlook.com domain, the old loyalists of Hotmail have so far had the option to stay with the older user interface of switch to the beta. If you chose to stick with the tried and tested, be ready to get uprooted from your comfort zone.

Microsoft plans on transitioning all existing Hotmail accounts to Outlook by the summer of 2013. While the transition won't involve a change in email ID, calendars, contacts or folders, what will change is the user interface. Gone will be the softly curved navigation bars and buttons with their aged glass effect, to be replaced by flat, minimalist uni-tone bars and buttons. The great thing about Outlook is that it comes

with free Word, Excel and PowerPoint web-apps, so you can view and edit the respective attachments without leaving the browser. Another key app to find itself integrated into Outlook is SkyDrive, to ensure that attachment sizes never an issue. Other forms of integrations brought into Outlook.com is the Social integration, where it will bring in all your contacts' updates and respective feeds from Facebook and Twitter into one place, sort of like the People's Hub in Windows 8.

Yahoo Does its Own Spring-Cleaning

Yahoo! in early March announced it is shutting down seven products that weren't yielding any profit, including the mobile app for BlackBerry smartphones. Yahoo believes the move will help focus more on its important assets.



"After much thought and deliberation, we decide to shut down some products. Before making these decisions, we look at a variety of factors. The most critical question we ask is whether the experience is truly a daily habit that still resonates for all of you today," the company announced on its official blog.

Besides the Yahoo app for BlackBerry devices, the products set to be phased out are Yahoo App Search, Yahoo Clues, Yahoo Message Boards, Yahoo Updates API, Yahoo Clues and Yahoo Avatars. For exact details regarding the last dates the services will be active, refer to <http://dgit.in/WqapWU>.